

Thinking, Fast and Slow — Mastery Quiz

Author: Daniel Kahneman • 12 multiple-choice questions • Answer + explanation

Instructions: Choose the best answer before checking the answer and explanation.

1. What is System 1?

- A. Slow analytical reasoning
- B. Fast, automatic and intuitive thinking
- C. Long-term planning only
- D. Mathematical calculation only

Correct answer: B

Why: System 1 operates quickly with little conscious effort.

2. What is System 2?

- A. Automatic intuition
- B. Slow, effortful and deliberate reasoning
- C. Emotional reaction only
- D. Habit formation only

Correct answer: B

Why: System 2 requires conscious mental effort.

3. What is anchoring?

- A. Ignoring initial information
- B. Being influenced by an initial number or reference point
- C. Improving memory
- D. Avoiding estimates

Correct answer: B

Why: Initial information can disproportionately influence later judgments.

4. What is availability bias?

- A. Rare events are ignored
- B. Easily recalled examples feel more common or likely
- C. All data is weighted equally
- D. Memory has no influence

Correct answer: B

Why: Vivid or easily remembered events can distort probability judgments.

5. What is loss aversion?

- A. Gains always feel stronger
- B. Losses can feel more painful than equivalent gains
- C. People ignore losses
- D. Losses never affect decisions

Correct answer: B

Why: Losses often have a stronger psychological impact than equivalent gains.

6. Why are base rates important?

- A. They provide background statistical information
- B. They make intuition unnecessary
- C. They guarantee accuracy
- D. They eliminate uncertainty

Correct answer: A

Why: Base rates provide a useful outside reference for judging probabilities.

7. What is overconfidence?

- A. Underestimating ability
- B. Excessive confidence relative to actual accuracy
- C. Avoiding forecasts
- D. Using base rates

Correct answer: B

Why: People can feel highly certain while still being wrong.

8. When should you slow down thinking?

- A. For every trivial action
- B. When stakes, complexity or uncertainty are high
- C. Never
- D. Only during exercise

Correct answer: B

Why: Deliberate reasoning is especially valuable for consequential decisions.

9. What is representativeness?

- A. Judging probability partly by similarity to a stereotype or prototype
- B. Ignoring appearances
- C. Using only arithmetic
- D. Avoiding categories

Correct answer: A

Why: Similarity can sometimes override more relevant statistical information.

10. What does a decision checklist accomplish?

- A. It guarantees perfect decisions
- B. It prompts deliberate checks for predictable biases
- C. It removes all uncertainty
- D. It replaces evidence

Correct answer: B

Why: Checklists can interrupt automatic thinking and force useful questions.

11. Which statement is most accurate?

- A. Intuition is always wrong
- B. Deliberation is always better
- C. Both systems have strengths and failure modes
- D. Biases can be eliminated permanently

Correct answer: C

Why: The book presents both fast and slow thinking as useful, but vulnerable in different ways.

12. What is the core lesson?

- A. Trust every intuition
- B. Understand predictable errors and slow down when needed
- C. Never make decisions
- D. Ignore statistics

Correct answer: B

Why: Better judgment comes from recognizing when intuition can mislead and applying deliberate checks.

Scoring guide: 10–12 = strong mastery • 7–9 = good understanding • 4–6 = review the summary • 0–3
= reread the core concepts.